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A Double-edged Sword

With India's population overtaking that of China, the country needs to find solutions to perennial problems like low job growth and holistic social support

BY ANAND ADHIKARI

► **"WE NEED TO** worry about population explosion." That message was delivered by PM Narendra Modi from the ramparts of the Red Fort on India's 73rd Independence Day. He added that the rising population poses various challenges for the country and future generations. Now, the UNPF State of World Population 2023 report has released figures showing India overtaking China to become the world's most populated country with 1.43 billion people by mid-2023.

"A growing population of this size means additional job creation, creating infrastructure and providing healthcare, education, and social security," says Arun Singh, Global Chief Economist of Dun & Bradstreet. In that sense, India's growing population is certainly a challenge. But